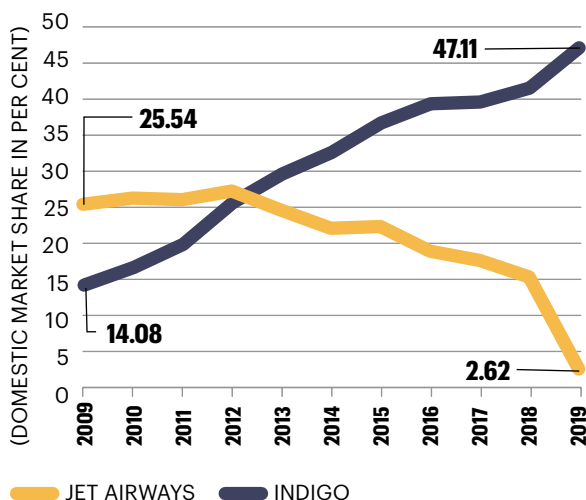


SKYDIVING

► JET LOST MARKET SHARE TO INDIGO ESPECIALLY AFTER 2012

► INDIGO HAD OVER 47 PER CENT MARKET SHARE WHEN JET SHUT DOWN IN 2019

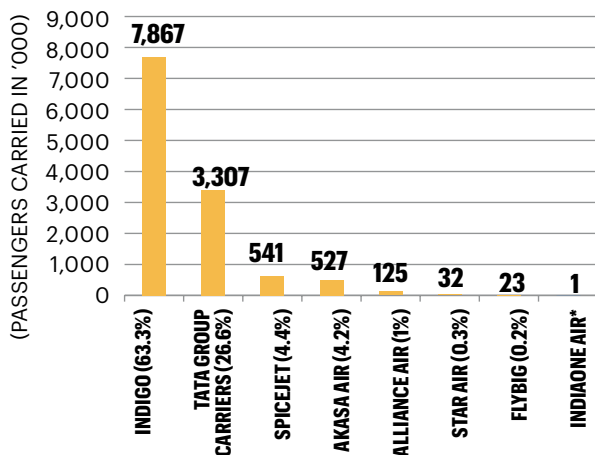


SOURCE DGCA, INDUSTRY, BT RESEARCH

MARKET FORCES

► JET AIRWAYS 2.0 WILL HAVE TO ADAPT TO A DRASTICALLY CHANGED MARKET

► INDIA MAY YET HAVE THE CAPACITY TO ABSORB A RELIABLE NEW CARRIER



FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE MARKET SHARE; DATA FOR AUGUST 2023; *NEGLIGIBLE; SOURCE DGCA

empowered to summon airline promoters and ask them to lay down the business plan in front of [it].”

A former senior Jet Airways executive who declined a job offer from the present owners last year, says, “To get an AOC with a four-year validity, the company needs to have five aircraft in operation within one year. However, the consortium does not have even one aircraft presently.” Further, with Jet Airways 2.0’s plans for a take-off getting delayed, and salary cuts being rolled out in the range of 50-100 per cent and subsequent exits, JKC’s staff strength may have depleted from a peak of around 200 last year to less than 100. Sources close to the consortium, however, continue to maintain that they have lined up a storied team for when they get ownership of the airline. “JKC continues to build a solid, powerful and dedicated team as part of its commitment to put the airline back in the air. The

consortium owners are very satisfied with the way the airline is being structured... It’s really unfortunate that an airline, which was ready to launch in September 2022 is not airborne yet,” they say, requesting anonymity as the discussions are not public. But they are finally hopeful of taking to the skies again, especially after the renewed support of the CoC.

SIGNS OF HOPE

But given the largely untapped potential of India’s air transport sector, many in the industry continue to see a chance for Jet’s revival. Domestic carriers ferried 100.61 million passengers in the January-August period, against the 77.07 million passengers during the corresponding period of the previous year, a 30.55 per cent year-on-year growth, according to DGCA data. Bhargava cites the example of ModiLuft, which returned as SpiceJet after folding up in 1996. “If the time lag is less, there are better chances of the airline coming and operating,” he says. Boeing’s Gupte has also reiterated the plane maker’s support for Jet Airways’ revival plans. “We always work very closely with our customers through good times and bad. That’s one of the things that really differentiates Boeing from our competitors.” In a nuanced tone, he tells BT, “We don’t fly passengers, nor do we fly cargo ourselves. Our